

Advanced Portfolio Management - Key Concepts for Portfolio X-Ray

Book Overview: "Advanced Portfolio Management: A Quant's Guide for Fundamental Investors" by Giuseppe Paleologo teaches fundamental equity investors how to use quantitative risk models and portfolio construction techniques to separate stock-specific alpha from systematic factor returns, manage risk effectively, and maximize risk-adjusted performance through proper position sizing and hedging.

Chapter 3-4: Factor Model Framework

Master Equation (Section 11.1.1)

$$r_t = \alpha + B_t * f_t + \varepsilon_t$$

Where:

- r_t : n-dimensional vector of asset total returns
- α : n-dimensional vector of expected returns (alphas)
- B_t : $n \times m$ matrix of factor loadings
- f_t : m-dimensional vector of factor returns
- ε_t : n-dimensional vector of idiosyncratic returns

Asset Covariance Matrix

$$\Omega_r = B * \Omega_f * B' + \Omega_\varepsilon$$

Where:

- Ω_r : Total return covariance
- Ω_f : Factor covariance matrix
- Ω_ε : Idiosyncratic covariance (usually diagonal)

Factor Return Estimation (Section 11.1.2)

For fundamental models, estimate factor returns via weighted least squares:

$$\min (r - B*f)' W (r - B*f)$$

$$\text{Solution: } \hat{f} = (B'WB)^{-1} * B'W * r$$

$$\text{Residuals: } \hat{\varepsilon} = (I - B(B'WB)^{-1} B'W) * r$$

Where W is diagonal with $W_{ii} = (\text{market_cap}_i)^{0.5}$

Chapter 5: Key Factors

Fama-French 3-Factor Model

1. **Market (MKT)**: Broad market return (SPY or S&P 500)
2. **Size (SMB)**: Small Minus Big - small cap premium
3. **Value (HML)**: High Minus Low - value premium (Book-to-Price)

Additional Factor: Momentum (MOM)

- 12-month momentum: returns over past year excluding most recent month
- Formula: $MOM = r(t-12, t-1)$ where t-1 excludes last month

Factor Loadings

- Market beta: Regression coefficient of stock returns on market returns
- Size: $\log(\text{market cap}) - \text{mean}(\log(\text{market cap})) / \text{std}$
- Value: Book-to-Price ratio, z-scored
- Momentum: Past 12-month return, z-scored

Chapter 6-7: Risk Decomposition

Portfolio Factor Exposure (Section 11.1.4)

$$b = B' * w$$

Where:

- w: portfolio weights (n-dimensional)
- b: factor exposures (m-dimensional)

Percentage Idiosyncratic Variance (Section 11.1.3)

$$\% \text{ idio var} = (w' * \Omega_{\varepsilon} * w) / (b' * \Omega_f * b + w' * \Omega_{\varepsilon} * w)$$

This measures purity of the portfolio:

- 100% = pure stock selection, no factor risk
- <75% = significant factor risk present

Marginal Contribution to Factor Risk (Section 11.1.5)

$$MCFR_i = [B * \Omega_f * b]_i / \sqrt{b' * \Omega_f * b}$$

Used to identify which positions contribute most to factor risk

Portfolio Beta to Benchmark (Section 11.1.4)

$$\beta(w,v) = (w' \cdot \Omega_r \cdot v) / (v' \cdot \Omega_r \cdot v)$$

Where v is the benchmark portfolio weights

Chapter 8: Performance Metrics

Sharpe Ratio (Section 6.1)

$$\text{Sharpe Ratio} = E[r] / \sigma(r)$$

Annualized from daily:

$$SR_{\text{annual}} = \sqrt{252} \cdot SR_{\text{daily}}$$

Information Ratio

$$IR = E[\varepsilon] / \sigma(\varepsilon)$$

Where ε is idiosyncratic return

Measures skill independent of factor exposures

Performance Attribution (Section 8.1.1)

$$\text{Total PnL} = \text{Idio PnL} + \text{Factor PnL}$$

$$\text{Factor PnL} = \sum (\text{exposure}_i \times \text{factor_return}_i)$$

$$\text{Idio PnL} = w' \cdot \varepsilon$$

Hit Rate and Diversification (Section 11.2)

$$IR = (2p - 1) \times \sqrt{N_{\text{eff}}} \times \sqrt{(2 \times 252 / \pi)}$$

Where:

- p : hitting probability (% of correct calls)

- N_{eff} : effective number of stocks = $\|w\|_1^2 / \|w\|_2^2$

Chapter 11: Key Formulas Reference

Factor-Mimicking Portfolios (Section 11.1.2)

$$V = (B'WB)^{-1} * B'W$$

Each column v_i is a portfolio that tracks factor i

These are used for hedging

Proportional Rule for Sizing (Section 11.4)

Given expected returns α , find factor-neutral positions:

1. Regress: $\alpha = B*x + \eta$
2. Residuals η are factor-neutral alphas
3. Position sizing: $NMV_i = (GMV / \Sigma|\eta_i|) \times \eta_i$

Risk-Based Sizing Options (Section 6.3)

1. **Proportional:** $NMV_i \propto \alpha_i$
2. **Risk Parity:** $NMV_i \propto \alpha_i / \sigma_i$
3. **Mean-Variance:** $NMV_i \propto \alpha_i / \sigma_i^2$

Book recommends Proportional for most cases.

Implementation Notes

Data Requirements

1. Portfolio holdings: Ticker, Shares, BuyDate, (optional) SellDate
2. Historical prices: Daily adjusted close prices
3. Factor returns: Can use Kenneth French data library or construct from market data

Risk Model Construction Steps

1. Load portfolio and fetch price history
2. Calculate stock returns
3. Fetch/construct factor returns (Market, Size, Value, Momentum)
4. Estimate factor loadings (betas) via regression
5. Calculate factor exposures: $b = B'w$
6. Decompose variance into factor and idio components
7. Calculate performance metrics

Fama-French Factor Construction

- **Market:** SPY or S&P 500 returns
- **Size (SMB):** Small cap index (IWM) - Large cap (SPY)
- **Value (HML):** Value ETF (IWD) - Growth ETF (IWG)
- **Momentum:** Can construct from cross-sectional stock returns

Or download directly from Kenneth French's data library:

https://mba.tuck.dartmouth.edu/pages/faculty/ken.french/data_library.html

Key Insights from Book

1. **Separate alpha from beta** (Ch 3): Focus on idiosyncratic returns
2. **Target 75%+ idio variance** (Ch 7): Keep factor risk low
3. **Proportional sizing works best** (Ch 6): Simple beats complex
4. **Diversification is key** (Ch 8): $N_{\text{eff}} = 50\text{-}200$ optimal
5. **Hit rate matters more than sizing** (Ch 8): Focus on selection

Output Requirements

1. Factor exposures (dollar and percentage)
2. % Idiosyncratic variance
3. Sharpe Ratio and Information Ratio
4. Performance attribution (factor vs idio)
5. Cumulative returns decomposition chart
6. Factor exposure bar chart
7. Excel export with all metrics